



Nikki: The data process works

I'm Nikki and I manage the education,
evaluation, assessment, and research team.

My favorite part of the data analysis process is finding
the hardest problem and asking
a million questions about it and
seeing if it's even possible to get an answer.

One of the problems that we've tackled here at
Google is our Noogler onboarding program,
which is how we onboard new hires.

One of the things that we've done is ask the question,
how do we know whether or
not Nooglers are onboarding faster
through our new onboarding program than
our old onboarding program where we used to lecture them.

We worked really closely with the content providers to
understand just exactly what
does it mean to onboard someone faster?

Once we asked all the questions,
what we did is we prepared
the data by understanding who was
the population of the new hires that we were examining.

We prepared our data by going through and understanding who our populations were, by understanding who our sample set was, who our control group was, who our experiment group was, where were our data sources, and make sure that it was in a set, in a format that was clean and digestible for us to write the proper scripts for.

So the next step for us was to process the data to make sure that it was in a format that we could actually analyze in SQL, making sure that was in the right format, in the right columns, and in the right tables for us.

To analyze the data, we wrote scripts in SQL and in R to correlate the data to the control group or the experiment group and interpret the data to understand, were there any changes in the behavioral indicators that we saw?

Once we analyze all the data, we want to report on it in a way that our stakeholders could understand.

Depending on who our stakeholders were, we prepared reports, dashboards

and presentations, and shared that information out.

Once all of our reports were complete,

we saw really positive results and decided to act on

it by continuing

our project-based learning onboarding program.

It was really satisfying to know that we have the data to

support it and that it really, really worked.

And not just that the data was there,

but that we knew that our students

were learning and that they were more productive,

faster back on their jobs.